



ANDREW TESTA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Britons drink billions of cups of tea yearly, but few cultivate it. A hotter climate led Mark Wyatt’s farm in Sussex, England, to grow it.

Tea-Sipping Nation Warms Up to Growing It, Too

By STEPHEN CASTLE

MOUNTFIELD, England — It was an overcast morning in August, and the humid air hanging over a gentle east-facing slope in England felt unnervingly tropical. “You could be in Sri Lanka,” said Mark Wyatt as he surveyed the dozens of rows of plants that stretched in front of us. Mr. Wyatt, the owner of 100 acres of land in the southeast area of Sussex, explained that this particular hillside, positioned between a nearby reservoir and a wood, inhabited a strange atmospheric pocket that trapped moisture. That happens to be ideal for the cultivation of his new crop: *Camellia sinensis*, more commonly known as tea. Britons have drunk tea for hundreds of years, importing it from China in the 17th century and

U.K. Farmers Try New Crops, Adapting to Climate Crisis

then, around 200 years later, from India. Billions of cups are consumed in Britain each year, usually black tea rather than green, and often topped up with milk. Yet few have attempted to grow it, let alone in the open air. A rapidly warming climate, however, may be changing that. “I thought we could create something interesting, something special and, with climate change coming through, all the headwinds seemed to become tailwinds,” Mr. Wyatt said. “It should get easier over time, as the temperature changes and so does the

nature of what is possible with passion, and a bit of science.” The past summer has been the hottest in recorded British history, with temperatures hitting 38.1 Celsius (100.6 Fahrenheit) and exceptionally dry conditions inflicting drought on much of the country. Many farmers have faced crises as potatoes emerge from the soil stunted or spoiled, wheat and oat yields fall and cows produce less milk. “The climate is a huge part of it,” said Prof. Carol Wagstaff, an expert in agriculture and crop science at the University of Reading. “If you add the uncertainties about the availability of labor, the geopolitical crises making energy very expensive, the challenges of sourcing fertilizer, you have this maelstrom affecting farming.” One of those crises — steadily

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G.O.P.’s Onus: Canada, Iran And Economy

By TONY ROMM

WASHINGTON — President Trump plunged the United States even deeper into a series of costly global conflicts this week, creating new economic hazards that have rattled financial markets, risked another rise in prices and unnerved some Republicans ahead of the 2026 election. On a day when Mr. Trump was set to rally G.O.P. voters ahead of the approaching midterms, the consequences of the president’s agenda were on full display. A trade war he initiated with Canada appeared headed toward another escalation, while a new outbreak of fighting in Iran sent oil prices above \$100 per barrel for the first time since July. Both developments threatened to unleash even higher costs on American families and businesses, which have already been stung by years of unchecked inflation that Mr. Trump has pledged to tame. The president’s attacks on Canada — and his new bid this week to block some of its exports to the United States altogether — risked damage to American states and domestic industries that rely heavily on commerce across the border. And his continuing war with Iran contributed to another spike in gas prices, with the average cost of a gallon of gas topping \$4.22 nationally on Wednesday. The fallout has complicated Mr. Trump’s task to convince a restive electorate that the nation is on the right track, almost two years since voters sent him back to the White House in the hopes that he would improve their finances. While the economy once might have served as Mr. Trump’s source of political strength, it has recently become his greatest liability, one that may jeopardize Republicans’ continued hold on the House and Senate in November. The changing political winds prompted even some members of Mr. Trump’s own party to try to distance themselves from the White House this week. As the president doubled down on his trade war with Canada, for example, Senator Susan Collins of Maine voiced her objections. A vulnerable candidate in a tough re-election fight this November, she pushed the Trump administration behind the scenes to relax a set of duties on road salt and

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WASHINGTON MEMO

Trump Posts Stream of A.I. And Pure Ego

Digital Fantasy of Self Grows Ever Wilder

By PETER BAKER

WASHINGTON — Just before noon on a holiday weekend, while many Americans were at the beach, President Trump’s social media account roared to life. In what has increasingly become his weekend habit, he unleashed a daylong barrage of posts that put the bully in the modern bully pulpit. There were images of Mr. Trump intimidating Canada’s prime minister with a hockey stick, personally bombing enemy targets and patrolling dark streets with killer robots. There were maps showing the United States taking over other countries, and maps renaming a state. There were attacks on the “Dumocratic Party” and tributes to himself as “the Greatest President of All Time!”

The 60 messages posted online over 10 hours and 41 minutes offered a window into Mr. Trump’s own unique reality, one anchored not in fact but in an expression of ego. For years, his social media feed was said to be a mirror of his id. But with A.I., it has become the manifestation of how he wants to be seen in a more visual, visceral way than ever before — as a warrior, as a conqueror, as a historical figure, as a younger and thinner and more muscular version of himself.

In Mr. Trump’s digitally enhanced version of the world, he is a giant in every way, a man who defeats every adversary, overcomes every obstacle and sinks every putt. He not only redraws the map of the world but vanquishes the heavens themselves. “The Moon Is Ours,” declared one post last weekend with an image of the earth’s only satellite. Another posted a few weeks ago showed him leading an extraterrestrial alien in shackles. The rat-a-tat of ever wilder, ever more outrageous posts each weekend has become a fixture of the president’s second term, seen more and more as a barometer of his mental state. Mr. Trump’s critics, who never considered

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MIDTERMS The president’s ability to still connect with voters’ concerns will be tested. PAGE A12

OPPOSING ORDERS ON MISSOURI MAP CREATE DISARRAY

PIVOTAL FOR MIDTERMS

U.S. Court Tells State to Use a District Layout Denied by a Justice

By ANN E. MARIMOW and MITCH SMITH

Conflicting court orders issued on the same day have thrown congressional elections in Missouri into chaos, two months before an election in which a handful of races could decide control of the House. On Tuesday, Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh denied a request from Missouri officials to use a congressional map that was redrawn to give Republicans an edge in the midterm elections, but had been blocked by the state’s Supreme Court.

Soon after, a Federal District Court judge in Missouri ruled the other way, ordering the state to rely on that map, which had been used in last month’s primary election. Missouri’s Republican attorney general and governor quickly said that the state intended to use the redrawn map, prompting the State Supreme Court to consider whether the state’s top election officer should be held in contempt. On Wednesday, opponents of the redistricting appealed to Justice Kavanaugh to block the district judge’s ruling.

Taken together, the dueling court orders left Missouri where it began, with no agreement about which congressional map should be in effect in November and no immediate route to resolving that question.

Missouri’s confusion comes amid a spate of redistricting across the country normally not seen more than once a decade after each census. It began last year after President Trump pressured some G.O.P.-controlled states including Texas to create more Republican seats, prompting some Democratic-controlled states including California to reciprocate. More redrawing followed this year after the United States Supreme Court weakened protections for districts drawn to benefit minorities.

Many states are also waiting to see whether the Supreme Court allows the U.S. Post Office to carry out a contentious plan to screen the recipients of mail-in ballots, a result of Mr. Trump’s belief, with-

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A Refugee’s Detention by ICE Set a Clock Ticking

By AMY QIN

ST. JOHNS, Mich. — Lue Yang had just finished his overnight shift at a Michigan automotive plant when two unmarked cars with tinted windows pulled into the parking lot and blocked him in. A man in body armor approached him. Mr. Yang knew that it was Immigration and Customs Enforcement. And, in those early morning hours of July 15, 2025, he knew why the agent was there. Nearly three decades earlier, as a teenager, Mr. Yang had spent 10 months in jail after he and three friends were caught with stolen cash, electronics and cameras in the trunk of their car. The consequences did not end there. Mr. Yang was living in the United States as a war refugee. After his conviction, he lost his permanent residency status and was ordered deported to Laos, the country his family had fled. For 23 years, the government did not enforce the final removal order. Mr. Yang went back to school, got married, had six children, built a career and became a leader in the Hmong community in Lansing, Mich. He checked in with ICE as required. He was never arrested again, said his lawyer, Nancy Xiong. Now ICE had come for him as part of President Trump’s deportation campaign. The agent agreed to escort Mr. Yang to his home in St. Johns, north of Lansing, so he could drop off his motorcycle before being



ROSEM MORTON FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Lue Yang, in the U.S. since 1979, was to be flown to Laos. His wife and the Hmong community scrambled to get him freed.

locked up. Mr. Yang gripped the handlebars and tried to stay under the speed limit during the 35-minute ride through verdant fields of corn and soybeans. As he approached home, he called his wife, Ann Vue, and asked her to come outside. Their children, the younger ones in paja-

mas, trudged down the long gravel driveway alongside her. Mr. Yang hugged each child, and then, before agents placed him in handcuffs, he turned to his wife. “Look for me,” Mr. Yang said as they embraced. “Don’t let me disappear.”

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As Notes to 9/11 Victims Fade, So Does a Path Toward Justice

By CAROL ROSENBERG

GUANTÁNAMO BAY, Cuba — A few years ago, relatives of people killed in the Sept. 11 attacks began leaving messages at a monument in Guantánamo Bay near the courtroom built to put terrorism suspects on trial. It was a way to remember a loved one in the enormity of the tragedy. Inside a heart drawn on a stone, Deborah Garcia wrote a love note to her husband, David, and left it beneath the American flag at the site. “Here to get you justice,” someone else wrote on a conch shell. “Never forget 9/11,” another message said. The words are now all gone. With the approaching 25th anniversary of the attacks that changed the United States, a grim reality has overtaken the place of remembrance. The messages, written on shells, stones and chunks of coral, have been washed away by tropical rains and bleached white by



MARISA SCHWARTZ TAYLOR/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Loved ones’ messages at Guantánamo Bay, Cuba, in 2023.

the Caribbean sun. Time and justice have not been kind to the families of the nearly 3,000 men, women and children who were killed on Sept. 11, 2001. The 19 hijackers died in the attack, and U.S. commandos hunted down and killed Osama bin Laden in 2011. But none of the five pris-

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The state is considering extending the life of its last power plant and allowing new reactors to be built. PAGE B1

Strife at the Northern Border

Americans have had symbiotic relationships with Canadians, but the trade war is testing those bonds. PAGE B1

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Grieving for Tibetans Online

With scarce details from China about flood victims, messages on social media are intimate portraits of loss. PAGE A4

Signaling Readiness to Escalate

Iran, facing rising U.S. pressure, is taking an increasingly aggressive approach. News Analysis. PAGE A9

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Transformer of Table Settings

Niels Refsgaard, a ceramist and designer for Dansk, created dishware that reflected the casual dining style of the late 1960s and ’70s. He was 91.

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Cuban Victims of Crash

Days after an Amazon cargo jet plowed into a van in Miami, portraits of those killed started to emerge. PAGE A14

Chavez-Tied Foundations Sued

Two organizations linked to Cesar Chavez are accused of failing to prevent the union leader’s abuse. PAGE A15

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49ers Fans Go Long

San Francisco, the most popular N.F.L. team in Australia, will have plenty of supporters — local and otherwise — at Thursday’s game in Melbourne. PAGE B7



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Still Carrying the Torch

Black barbecues have long been a joyful, safe space. A new generation wants to keep the fires burning. PAGE D1

The Fashion Whisperer

St. John Knits has chosen Humberto Leon as its creative director, hoping to revitalize the brand’s image. PAGE D5

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Moving Beyond Adversity

Twenty-five years after 9/11 caused the cancellation of a Bill T. Jones show, he debuts a work in response. PAGE C1

No-Shows on the Red Carpet

Big studios and stars were AWOL from this fall’s prestigious film festivals, forcing organizers to scramble. PAGE C1

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